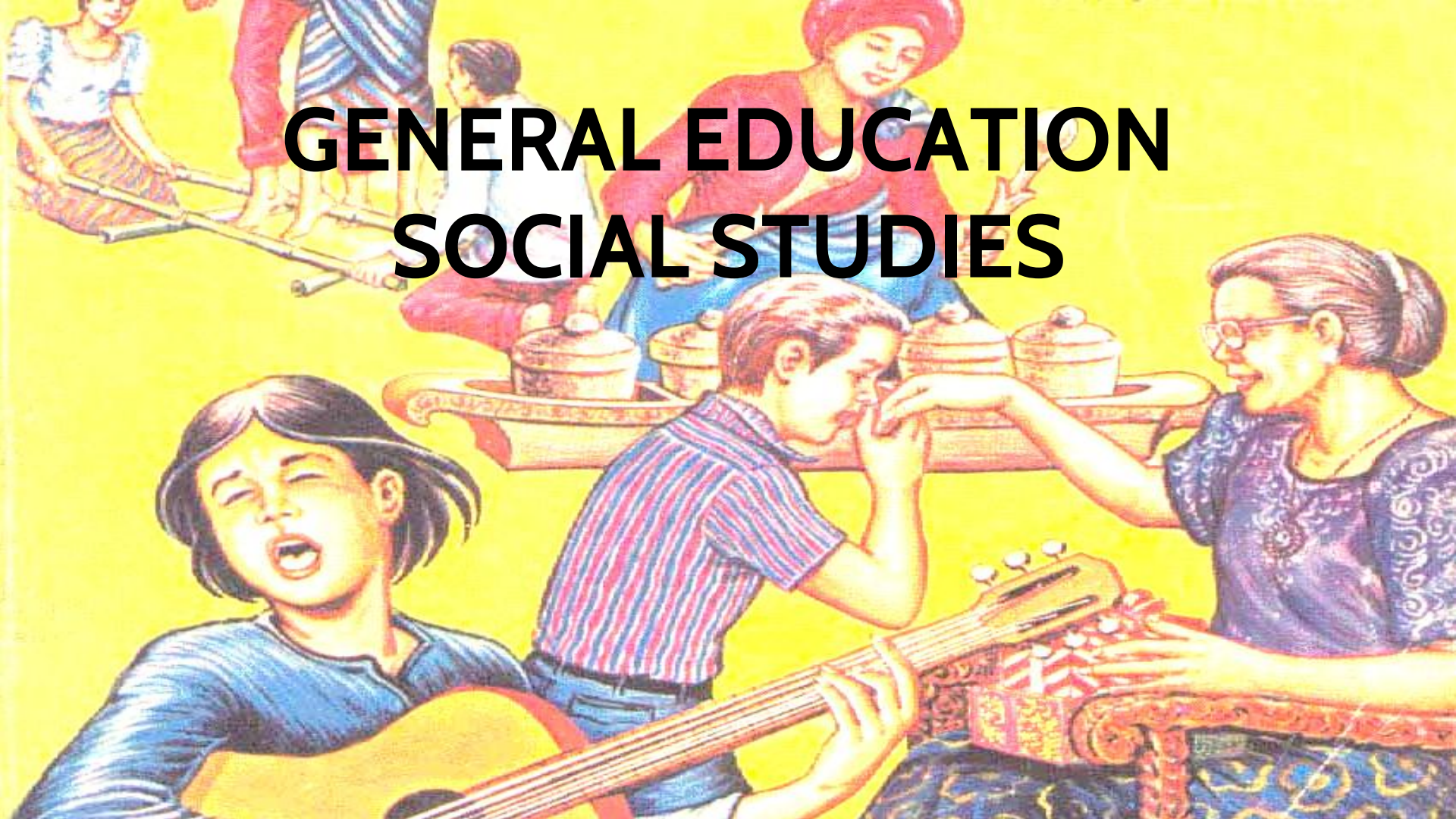




GENERAL EDUCATION SOCIAL STUDIES

CULTURE & SOCIETY

SOCIETY

- ✓ A distinct and relatively autonomous community whose members' mutual social relations are embedded in and expressed through the medium of culture.'
- ✓ Any portion of a community regarded as a unit distinguishable by particular aims or standards of living or conduct'. i.e. culture
- ✓ A group of people who occupy a specific locality and who share the same cultural traditions or culture.'

SOCIAL PARADIGMS

- **Theory:** a systematic explanation of how two or more phenomena are related
- **Paradigm:** a set of fundamental assumptions that guides thinking
- **Sociological imagination (C. Wright Mills)**
 - Examining personal experiences in the context of the larger social structure

STRUCTURAL-FUNCTIONALISM

- **Focus** – balance in societies
- **Basics**
 - Views society as a complex system with many interdependent parts
 - Parts work together to promote social stability and order; system seeks to maintain equilibrium
- **Function**
 - Consequences of a given social pattern
 - Either manifest or latent
 - A macro-oriented (large-scale) paradigm

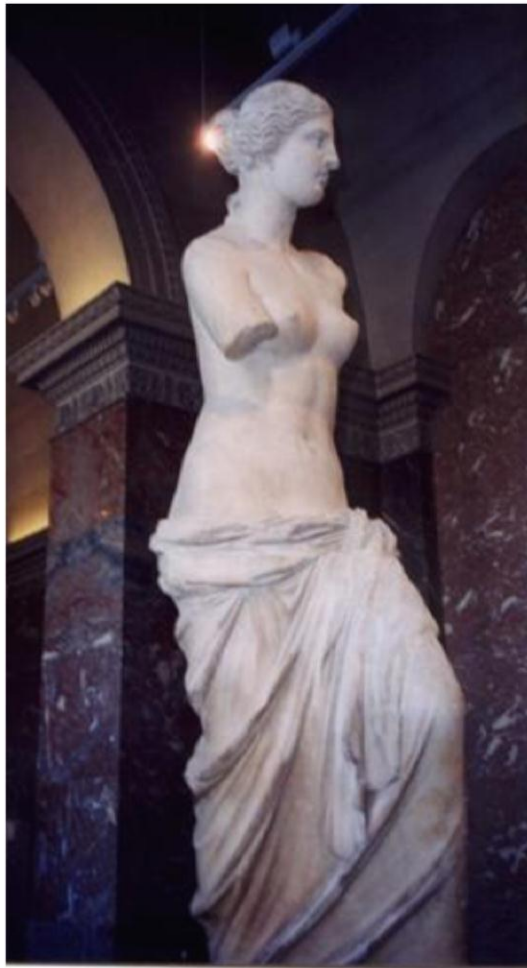
CONFLICT PERSPECTIVE

- **Focus** – Forces that divide people and the resulting domination and exploitation
- **Basics**
 - Society consists of institutions that dominant groups have established to reinforce their status
 - Society = a structured system based on **inequality**
 - Factors such as race, sex, class, and age are linked to social inequality
 - **Social conflict** between groups over scarce resources is the norm
 - A macro-oriented paradigm

SYMBOLIC INTERACTIONISM

- ***Focus*** – How people interact with one another
- ***Basics***
 - Society is the product of everyday interactions
 - Social patterns and processes are creations of people interacting with one another
 - Communication between individuals that occurs through symbols
 - ***George Herbert Mead*** – Symbols are the essence of social life and are interpreted by other people

CULTURE



The knowledge, language, values, customs, and material objects that are passed from person to person and from one generation to the next in a human group or society

CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

- ✓ Culture is learned
- ✓ Culture is unconscious
- ✓ Culture is shared
- ✓ Culture is integrated
- ✓ Culture is symbolic
- ✓ Culture is a way of life
- ✓ Culture is dynamic
- ✓ Culture is relative



ELEMENTS OF CULTURE

Material Culture

- The physical or tangible (see, touch) objects that members of a society make, use, and share
- Raw Materials → Technology → Stuff

Non-Material Culture

- The abstract or intangible human creations of society that influences people's behavior
- Language, beliefs, values, rules of behavior, family patterns, political systems

Symbols

- Anything that meaningfully represents something else

ELEMENTS OF CULTURE

Language

- A set of symbols that expresses ideas and enable people to think and communicate with one another

Values

- Collective ideas about what is right or wrong, good or bad, and desirable or undesirable in a particular culture

Norms

- Established rules of behavior or standards of conduct

ELEMENTS OF CULTURE

Folkways

- Standards of behavior that are socially approved but not morally significant

Mores

- Norms of morality

Taboos

- Subjects or behaviors absolutely forbidden by a culture

Laws

- formal rules enacted by the state

SUBCULTURE

A category of people who share distinguishing attributes, beliefs, values, and/or norms that set them apart in some significant manner from the dominant culture. (form around common ethnic/religious heritage, SES, occupation)



COUNTERCULTURE

- A group that strongly rejects dominant societal values and norms and seeks alternative lifestyles.
- Also a subculture



WHAT IS DEVIANCE?

- Any behavior, belief, or condition that violates significant social norms in the society or group in which it occurs.
- Interestingly – one who is considered “deviant” by one category of people may be seen as “conformist” in another group.
- It depends on the time, place and context in which it occurs, and on the people who define and apply the norms.

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

- The organization of social positions and the distribution of people among them
- **Micro level**
 - Individual behavior is shaped by statuses and roles
 - Status: position in a social structure that determines where a person fits in a society
 - Role: set of expected behavior patterns, obligations and privileges

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

Micro level

- ***Role conflict*** – occurs when one is pulled in different directions from different statuses
- ***Role strain*** – incompatible demands are built into a single status

Macro level – Social institutions

- Widely accepted, relatively stable clusters of roles, statuses and groups that are designed to satisfy the basic needs of a society

SOCIAL STRATIFICATION

- The division of society into layers, or strata of people who have unequal amounts of scarce but desirable resources
- Refers to inequality among groups of people, not individuals
- ***Social mobility*** – The movement of people from one social position to another

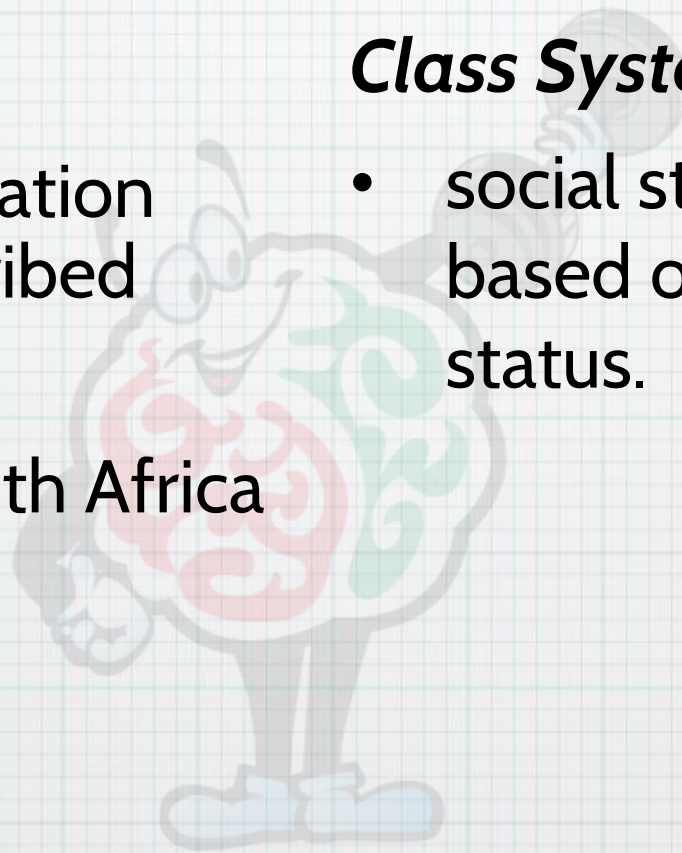
TYPES OF STRATIFICATION SYSTEMS

Caste System

- social stratification based on ascribed status.
- India and South Africa

Class System

- social stratification based on achieved status.



WHAT IS DIVERSITY?

- Cultural diversity refers to the wide range of cultural differences found between and within nations
- Can be a result of natural circumstances (climate, geography) or social circumstances (technology or demographics)
- Societies can be homogeneous or heterogeneous

ETHNOCENTRISM

- The practice of judging all other cultures by one's own culture
- Based on the assumption that one's own way of life is superior to all others
- Can be positive or negative



CULTURAL RELATIVISM

The belief that the behaviors and customs of any culture must be viewed and analyzed by the culture's own standards or within the context of a particular society's responses to problems and opportunities



CULTURAL UNIVERSALS

Customs and practices that occur across all societies



SOCIALIZATION

- The lifelong process of social interaction through which individuals acquire a self-identity and the physical, mental, and social skills needed for survival in society.
- All societies socialize their young.



THE LOOKING GLASS SELF

- Imagine how your personality and appearance looks to other people
- How are they judging you?
- Is your self-concept favorable or unfavorable?
- **Cooley** – interaction with others is critical for socialization

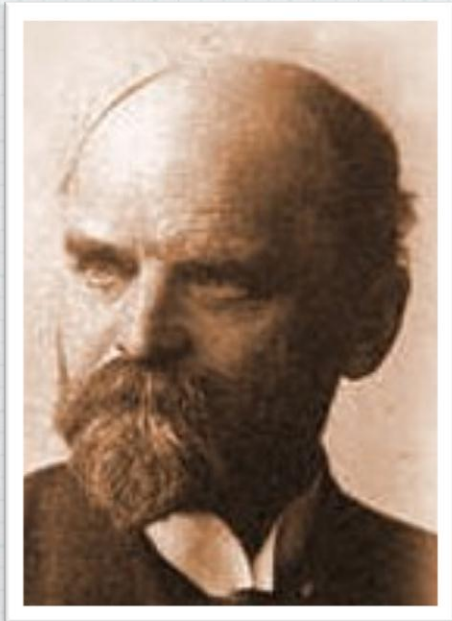




COMMUNITY RELATIONS

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COMMUNITY RELATIONS

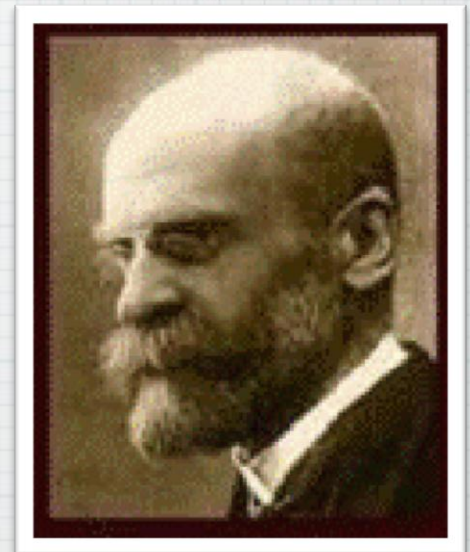


Ferdinand Tönnies

Gemeinschaft and Gesellschaft

Emile Durkheim

Mechanical and Organic Solidarity



GEMEINSCHAFT VS GESSELSCHAFT

- ***Gemeinschaft*** (often translated as *community*) is an association in which individuals are oriented to the large association.
- Individuals in Gemeinschaft are regulated by common mores or beliefs.
- Gemeinschafts are broadly characterized by a moderate division of labor, strong personal relationships, strong families, and relatively simple social institutions.

GEMEINSCHAFT VS GESSELLSCHAFT

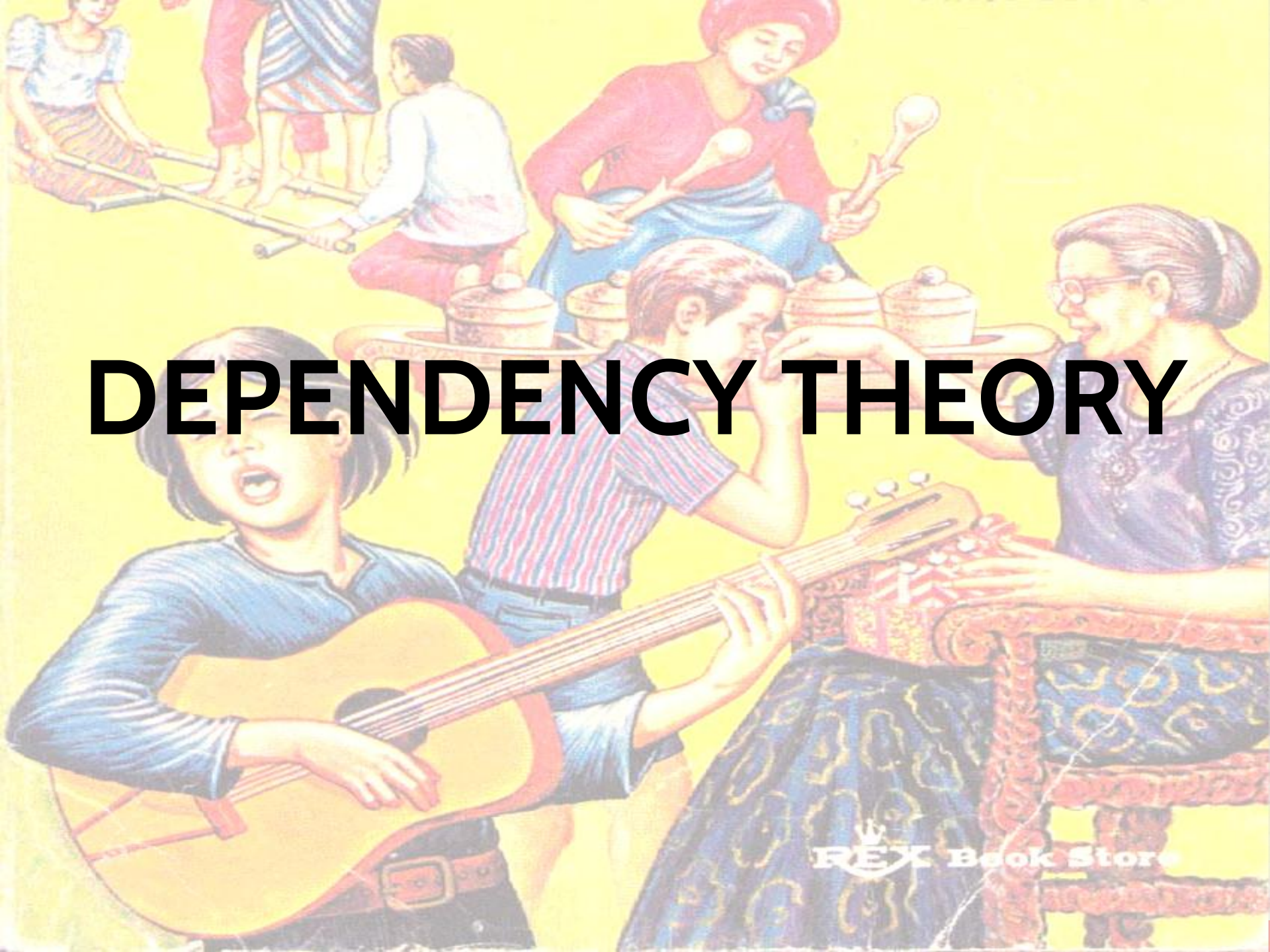
- ***Gesellschaft*** (often translated as *society*).
- Gesellschaft is maintained through individuals acting in their own self interest.
- Emphasizes secondary relationships rather than familial or community ties, and there is generally less individual loyalty to society.
- Social cohesion in Gesellschafts typically derives from a more elaborate division of labor.

MECHANICAL SOCIETIES VS ORGANIC SOCIETIES

- Mechanical solidarity applies to societies in which all members have common and shared social experiences, and special subdivisions within a society are either absent or weak.
- Because of this homogeneity, each individual is directly and equally attached to the society.

MECHANICAL SOCIETIES VS ORGANIC SOCIETIES

- Organic solidarity societies are formed by a system of different organs, each of which has a specific role.
- Because individuals' tasks do not cover all aspects of their survival, they need to depend on each other to live in the society.
- They are held together to each other by one central organ which controls the rest of the organism.



DEPENDENCY THEORY

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DEPENDENCY THEORY

“Dependence is a conditioning situation in which the economies of one group of countries are conditioned by the development and expansion of others.”

- Model of metropolis-satellite exploitation and extraction of economic surplus
- Has origins in the colonial eras; the satellites then become the colonial metropolises
- Development of the metropolis corresponds to and necessitates the underdevelopment of the satellites

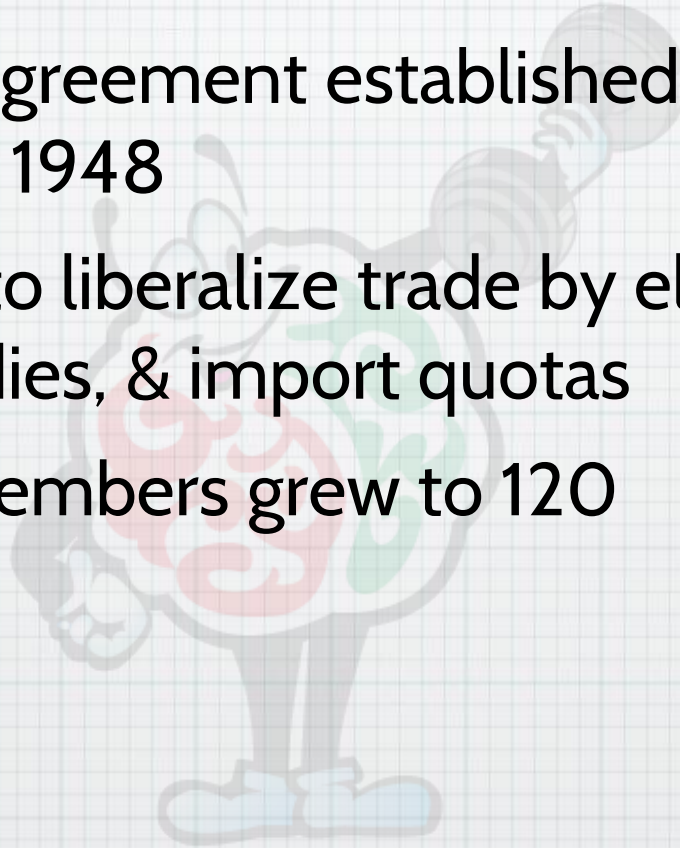


GATT & WTO

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GENERAL AGREEMENT ON TARIFFS AND TRADE

- Multilateral agreement established under US leadership in 1948
- Objective is to liberalize trade by eliminating tariffs, subsidies, & import quotas
- 19 original members grew to 120



WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION

The WTO was created during the Uruguay Round of GATT to police and enforce GATT rules

- “deals with the rules of trade between nations at a global or near-global level”

Formation of WTO had an impact on..

- Agriculture subsidies
- Applied GATT rules to services and intellectual property
- Strengthened GATT monitoring and enforcement



TERMS: ANTHROPOLOGY

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KEY TERMS

- ***Acculturation*** – culture change resulting from contact between cultures. A process of external culture change.
- ***Adaptation*** – patterns of behavior which enable a culture to cope with its surroundings.
- ***Assimilation*** – when one ethnic group absorbs another, so that the cultural traits of the assimilated group become indistinguishable. (minority incorporated into the majority)

KEY TERMS

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KEY TERMS

- ***Attitudes*** – data that describe how people think, believe, and feel.
- ***Bilingual education*** – teaching a second language by relying heavily on the native language of the speaker. The theory is that maintaining a strong sense of one's one culture and language is necessary to acquire another language and culture.
- ***Bureaucracy*** – government based on a specialized set of offices usually hierarchically organized.

KEY TERMS

- ***Caste system*** – the ranking of members in a society by occupational status and degree of purity or pollution as determined by their birth.
- ***Cultural transmission*** – how culture is passed on through learning from one generation to another. Also referred to as enculturation or socialization
- ***Discrimination*** – the act of disqualifying or mistreating people on grounds rationally irrelevant to the situation.
- ***Division of labor*** – the division of tasks in a society between women and men, old and young, ability, knowledge, experience.

KEY TERMS

- ***Economic development*** – the institutional changes made to promote economic betterment. It is the social organizational changes made to promote growth in an economy.
- ***Economic growth*** – the overall growth in an economy. Gross national product and gross domestic product are the usual measures of economic growth.
- ***Enculturation*** – the process of learning one's own culture, also called socialization.

KEY TERMS

- ***Equality*** – a measure of how similar people are to one another. It can be measured quantitatively with such measures as wealth concentration, Gini coefficients, and percentiles.
- ***Equity*** – the institutional arrangements to promote equality. Equity is not quantitatively measured; it is determined by people agreeing that their institutions are fair.
- ***Ethics*** – the principles of conduct governing an individual or group; concerns for what is right or wrong, good or bad.

KEY TERMS

- ***Extended family*** – a composite family composed of other relatives besides the nuclear families.
- ***Family of orientation*** – nuclear family consisting of oneself and one's father, mother and siblings.
- ***Family of procreation*** – nuclear family consisting of oneself and one's spouse and children.
- ***Gender*** – socially agreed-upon traits of men and women.

KEY TERMS

- ***Gross Domestic Product (GDP)*** - a measure of an economy's economic performance. It is the market value of all goods and services produced within the boundaries of a country.
- ***Gross National product (GNP)*** - a measure of an economy's economic performance. It is the market value of all goods and services produced by the residents of a particular country. It includes the income of those residents earned by corporations owned overseas and from working abroad.

KEY TERMS

- ***Hidden curriculum*** – set of unwritten rules of behavior that are taught in schools.
- ***Legitimacy*** – the right to hold and use power, usually based on the consent of the governed
- ***Multiculturalism*** – stressing the importance of different cultures, races, and ethnicities.
- ***Matriarchy*** – where a mother figure and women have authority.
- ***Patriarchy*** – where a father figure and males have authority.

KEY TERMS

- ***Polygamy*** – an individual who has more than one spouse.
- ***Polygyny*** – a man has more than one wife.
- ***Prejudice*** – categorical like or dislike of a group of people based on real or imagined characteristics.
- ***Religion*** – set of beliefs and practices that pertain to sacred things among a community of believers. (Durkheim: elements – sacred objects, beliefs, rituals and community).

KEY TERMS

- ***Qualitative methods*** – rich descriptions of cultural situations obtained from interviewing, participant observation, and collection of oral and textual materials. Ethnographies are reports from qualitative research.
- ***Quantitative methods*** – numerical tabulations and statistical comparisons made possible by systematic surveys, observations, or analysis of records. Data are used to test hypotheses and identify the strength of patterns observed using qualitative methods.
- ***Sex*** – the biological differentiation of male and female.